

Sun, Heat & the Body

Hot stones, sauna safety, and the single habit that prevents nearly every heat-related injury in this course

Learning Objectives

- Test and manage hot stone temperature safely throughout a service
- Apply correct time, hydration, and contraindication guidance for sauna and steam services
- Explain why freshly waxed or exfoliated skin needs specific sun-protection guidance
- Apply the single habit that prevents nearly every heat-related injury in this module

Heat is therapeutic and genuinely dangerous, in the same breath

Warmth relaxes muscle and eases circulation beautifully — and heat, mismanaged even slightly, burns skin permanently. This module holds both truths together, the same way Course I held sun exposure's benefits and risks together for skin.

Hot stone safety

Basalt stones used in hot stone massage typically hold heat at 50–55°C (122–131°F) for professional use — hot enough to feel deeply warming, but calibrated below the threshold that causes burns on healthy, unbroken skin within a reasonable contact time. Never estimate stone temperature by feel through a towel; use a thermometer, and always test directly on your own inner wrist or forearm before the stone ever touches a client. Reduce temperature further, or avoid hot stone work entirely, for clients with diabetes, impaired sensation, thin or fragile skin, or any of the circulatory contraindications from Module Three.



Never estimate heat through a towel — direct skin contact on your own wrist is the only reliable check.

Sauna and steam room guidance

- **Time limits.** Fifteen to twenty minutes is a reasonable general ceiling for most healthy adults per session; longer sessions raise dehydration and overheating risk without added benefit.
- **Hydration.** Recommend water before and after, never during a session near heat, when a client may not notice early dehydration signs.
- **Contraindications.** Pregnancy, uncontrolled hypertension, cardiac conditions, and any of the medical cautions from Module Three all warrant checking with a doctor before sauna or steam use, not just before massage.

Freshly treated skin and sun exposure

Waxing, exfoliation, and udvartana all remove or thin the skin's outer protective layer temporarily, leaving it measurably more vulnerable to UV damage immediately afterward — on top of the phototoxic essential oil risk from Module Four. Advise every client to avoid direct sun exposure and to apply broad-spectrum sunscreen diligently on any freshly treated area for at least twenty-four to forty-eight hours, extending Course I's sun-safety principle into the spa treatment room specifically.

The single habit that prevents nearly every injury here

Test on your own skin, every time, before any heated tool or stone touches a client — never on the assumption that "it was fine last time." This one habit, applied without exception, is responsible for preventing the overwhelming majority of heat-related injuries this module exists to address.

Key Terms

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[object Object]

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Practical Activity · The Temperature Check

Using a thermometer, heat a set of stones to the professional range taught in this module, and test each individually on your own wrist before use, narrating the check aloud. Write a short aftercare note advising sun protection for a client following a waxing service.